05-09 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） Where Does Rain Really Come From?

① When we are young, the answer to the question "Where does rain come from?" sounds simple: from the clouds. But that answer only pushes the real question a little higher into the sky. Where do the clouds themselves come from? And how do soft, white clouds turn into the noisy grey rain that wakes us up at night? The full story is a beautiful journey between the oceans, the air, and our own heads.

② The journey starts at the **surface of water**. Every day, the sun heats the seas, rivers, lakes and even the wet soil. A small part of that water changes from liquid into an invisible gas called **water vapour**. This quiet change is called **evaporation**. On a hot day, an open glass of water slowly becomes empty for the same reason. Scientists believe that our planet lifts thousands of billions of litres of water into the air in this way every day.

③ This warm wet air rises high into the sky, because warm air is lighter than cool air. As it rises, the air gets colder. When the air becomes cold enough, the invisible water vapour **cools** down and turns back into tiny water drops. This second change is called **condensation**. Millions of these tiny drops gather around even tinier pieces of dust. Together they form a cloud.

④ At first, the drops in a cloud are small and light — light enough to float. A group of cloud drops is a bit like a crowd of very light balloons. But as the cloud grows colder and bigger, drops keep meeting and joining each other. A big drop is too heavy to float. At some point, many drops together fall out of the cloud. We call this **precipitation** — the general name for rain, drizzle, snow and hail.

⑤ Whether the water falls as rain or as snow depends on the **temperature** near the ground. If the air between the cloud and the roof is warm enough, the drops stay as liquid, and we see rain. If the air is very cold, the drops freeze and become snowflakes. If strong winds push ice drops up and down inside tall clouds, they can grow into hard balls of ice — **hailstones**.

⑥ The journey does not end on the ground. Rainwater flows into streams, streams join rivers, rivers reach the sea — and the sun begins the story again. This endless circle has a name: the **water cycle**. Next time you stand under an umbrella listening to the rain, remember: those drops may have been floating over the Pacific Ocean two weeks ago, and may pass through your schoolyard garden before travelling on to someone else's sky.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the first step in the journey that finally produces rain?

A. Water falling from the moon.
B. The sun heating water, which then becomes water vapour (evaporation).
C. Clouds pushing each other.
D. Snow melting on the mountains.

2. What does the word "condensation" in paragraph ③ refer to?

A. Water vapour turning back into tiny water drops.
B. Water drops turning into salt.
C. Water drops being eaten by the sun.
D. Water drops disappearing into space.

3. According to the passage, why do rain drops finally fall from a cloud?

A. Because the cloud wants to fall asleep.
B. Because many small drops join into bigger drops that are too heavy to float.
C. Because lightning pushes them down.
D. Because birds peck them out.

4. What decides whether the falling water is rain, snow, or hail?

A. The colour of the sky.
B. The time of day.
C. The temperature of the air between the cloud and the ground, and the winds inside tall clouds.
D. The size of the clouds only.

5. Which is the BEST title for this passage?

A. A Short History of Umbrellas.
B. Why We Drink Water Every Day.
C. The Sky Journey of a Rain Drop: The Water Cycle.
D. How to Build a Rain-Gauge at Home.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "the sun heats the seas... water changes from liquid into... water vapour...

evaporation."
【解析】雨的形成始于太阳加热水，水变成水蒸气。A/C/D 均与原文不符。故选 B。

2.
【答案】A
【题型】词义猜测题
【定位】第③段第3句 "the invisible water vapour cools down and turns back into tiny water drops. This second change is called condensation."
【解析】"condensation" 指水蒸气变回小水滴。B/C/D 均无依据。故选 A。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "drops keep meeting and joining each other. A big drop is too heavy to float."
【解析】小水滴聚合成大水滴，重到无法漂浮就落下。A/C/D 均属无中生有。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "the temperature near the ground... If strong winds push ice drops up and down inside tall clouds..."
【解析】降雨/雪/冰雹取决于地面附近温度和云内上下气流。A/B/D 均不完整或无据。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】全文围绕 "水循环" 展开，末段 "water cycle"
【解析】文章讲雨滴的天空之旅即水循环。A 伞的历史、B 喝水、D 雨量计均非中心。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **evaporation** [n.] 蒸发
- **condensation** [n.] 凝结
- **precipitation** [n.] 降水
- **hailstone** [n.] 冰雹